

Sir Corven Duskvale — Human Paladin (Oath of Devotion)



Figure 1: Character portrait

Class: Paladin (Oath of Devotion, locked)

Race: Variant Human

Level: 3

Role: Front-line gish / team buffer / single-hit nova via Smite

Personality Hook: *Smiles at the monster. Prays for its soul. Then smites it anyway.*

Core Stats

Ability Scores (Point Buy 27, +2 Variant Human)

Ability	Score	Mod
STR	16	+3
DEX	10	+0
CON	14	+2
INT	8	-1
WIS	10	+0
CHA	15	+2

Variant Human applied +1 STR / +1 CHA.

Combat Vitals

- **HP:** 38 (base 28 at L3 with CON 14 + **10 HP variant buffer**)
- **AC:** 16 (Chain Mail, no shield — using two-handed weapon)
- **Speed:** 30 ft
- **Initiative:** +0
- **Proficiency Bonus:** +2
- **Hit Dice:** 3d10

Saving Throws: WIS +2, CHA +4

Skill Proficiencies: Athletics +5, Intimidation +4, Persuasion +4 (Variant Human extra skill)

Senses: Divine Sense (3/day — detect celestial/fiend/undead in 60 ft)

Languages: Common, Celestial

Spell Save DC: 12 · **Spell Attack:** +4

Equipment

- **Greatsword** (2d6 slashing, heavy, two-handed) — primary weapon
- **5x Javelin** (1d6 piercing, thrown 30/120) — opening turns, switch-weapon cost-free
- **Chain Mail** (AC 16, disadv on Stealth) — starting armor
- **Holy Symbol** (amulet, worn) — spellcasting focus
- **Priest's Pack** (prayer book, vestments, 5 sticks incense, tinderbox, candles, alms box, rations, waterskin)
- **Starting trinket:** A locket containing a lock of hair from the person he's sworn to protect

Feat: Great Weapon Master (variant -3 / +6)

Per Arena variant rules: Power Attack is **-3 to hit, +6 damage** (modified from -5/+10).

- **Trigger on crit or drop:** Scoring a crit or dropping a creature to 0 HP with a melee weapon gives you a **bonus-action melee attack** immediately. **Massive synergy with Smite.**
- **Heavy weapon power attack:** Before a melee attack with a heavy weapon, choose to take -3 attack for +6 damage on a hit.

Class & Race Features

Paladin (L3)

- **Divine Sense** (CHA mod + 1 = 3/long rest): Action, detect celestials/fiends/undead in 60 ft.

- **Lay on Hands:** Pool of **15 HP** ($5 \times$ Paladin level). Bonus action to heal an ally you touch. Can also cure disease/poison for 5 HP.
- **Fighting Style — Great Weapon Fighting:** Reroll 1s and 2s on weapon damage dice when wielding a 2H weapon (once per roll per die).
- **Spellcasting (L2):** CHA-based. Prepared = CHA mod + half level = **3 prepared spells**.
- **Divine Smite:** On a melee weapon hit, expend a spell slot to deal extra radiant damage — **+2d8** for 1st-level, **+3d8** for 2nd-level, **+1d8 vs fiends/undead**. Declared **AFTER** the hit is confirmed (so no wasted slots on misses).
- **Divine Health:** Immune to disease.
- **Sacred Oath — Oath of Devotion (L3):**
 - **Channel Divinity (1/short rest):** Pick one of:
 - * **Sacred Weapon:** Action, for 1 minute your weapon deals +CHA (+2) to attack rolls, counts as magical, and emits 20 ft bright light.
 - * **Turn the Unholy:** Action, 30 ft, fiends/undead WIS save vs turn.
 - **Oath Spells Always Prepared (don't count vs limit):**
 - * 1st: Protection from Evil and Good, Sanctuary

Variant Human

- **+1 to two abilities** (applied: STR, CHA)
- **Extra Skill** (Persuasion)
- **Feat:** Great Weapon Master (variant -3/+6)

Spell Slots & Preparation

Slots: $3 \times$ 1st (no 2nd-level slots until L5)

Prepared Spells (3 chosen + 2 oath spells always prepared):

- **Bless** (*1st, concentration, 1 min*) — You + 2 allies add 1d4 to attack rolls AND saving throws. Team-wide buff. **Cast turn 1, maintain concentration. Whole-arena duration.**
- **Command** (*1st, 30 ft, WIS save*) — Force one-word command (“Flee”, “Grovel”, “Drop”, “Halt”). Burn a slot to waste an enemy turn.
- **Cure Wounds** (*1st, touch, 1d8 + CHA*) — Emergency single-target heal for ~6 HP.

Always Prepared (Oath of Devotion):

- **Protection from Evil and Good** (*1st, concentration, 10 min*) — Ally can't be charmed/frightened by fiends/undead; they have disadvantage to hit the protected ally. Situational.
- **Sanctuary** (*1st, bonus action, 1 min*) — Target who wants to attack the warded creature makes a WIS save or picks a different target. Great on a low-HP ally.

Note — Sleep is banned and isn't on the Paladin list anyway.

Signature Tactical Moves

1. **Sacred Smite Nova.** Hit with Greatsword (+5 to hit, or -3 for +6 GWM). On hit, declare **Divine Smite** — burn a 1st-level slot for **+2d8 radiant** (avg +9). Total damage: $2d6$ GWF + 3 STR + $2d8$ = **avg 19, avg 25 with GWM**. On a crit: all weapon + smite dice double = **avg 40+**. If the crit drops the target, **Great Weapon Master bonus-action attack** — free swing, smite again if slots remain.
2. **Bless the Team Turn 1.** Round 1 action: cast Bless on self + 2 allies. Concentration, 1 minute (lasts the whole fight per v1 rules unless broken). All three Blessed allies add 1d4 to every attack roll

and save for the fight. **Probably the highest-EV turn-1 action any character in the roster can take.** Follow-up turns: Greatsword attacks, Smite on big hits.

3. **Sacred Weapon + Bless Combo.** Round 1: Bless (action). Round 2: **Channel Divinity — Sacred Weapon** (action): weapon gains +2 CHA to attacks + magical for 1 min. Stack with Bless (+1d4) = +2 flat + 1d4 to every attack. Expected hit rate approaches 90% against most AC targets. Pair with GWM power attacks (now -3 is mostly offset) for bigger damage per swing.

Action Economy (Quick Reference)

Slot	Options
Action	Attack (Greatsword 2d6+3 slash, GWF reroll 1s/2s; or Javelin 1d6+3 thrown) · Cast Spell (Bless, Command, Cure Wounds) · Channel Divinity — Sacred Weapon (1/SR) · Dash · Dodge
Bonus Action	Lay on Hands (heal from 15 HP pool) · Sanctuary (cast as 1st-level slot — but it's 1 action, not bonus; use it via standard Action if needed) · GWM bonus attack (on crit or kill)
Reaction	Opportunity Attack
Movement	30 ft
Free	Divine Smite declaration (after a hit is confirmed)

Damage Reference

- **Greatsword baseline:** 2d6 (GWF) + 3 STR = **avg 11**
- **Greatsword + GWM (-3/+6):** 2d6 (GWF) + 3 + 6 = **avg 17** (lower hit chance)
- **Greatsword + 1st-level Smite:** 2d6 + 3 + 2d8 = **avg 20**
- **Greatsword + Smite + GWM:** 2d6 + 3 + 6 + 2d8 = **avg 26**
- **Greatsword crit + Smite:** 4d6 + 3 + 4d8 = **avg 33**
- **Greatsword crit + Smite + GWM:** 4d6 + 3 + 6 + 4d8 = **avg 39**, plus GWM bonus attack

Town Phase Notes

- **CHA 15 + Persuasion + Intimidation** — strongest social character in the martial slots. Leans hard into Haggling (General Shop), Hag's Riddles social angles, and Casino.
- **Athletics +5** — Training Grounds / any STR physical option.
- **Lay on Hands** lets the team stretch HP between combats (though v1 is typically single-fight — doesn't really matter).
- Weak at Library (INT 8), weak at Catacombs Perception (WIS 10, no Perception prof).